

Resume rubric

FREE TEMPLATE

A resume passes when every box is checked.

Format

- ☐ One page. No exceptions for first- and second-year students.
- ☐ One clean, standard font; 10-12 pt body; margins no smaller than 0.5 in.
- ☐ No photos, graphics, color blocks, skill bars, or two-column templates.
- ☐ Consistent dates, punctuation, and alignment on every line.
- ☐ Saved as a PDF named Firstname-Lastname-Resume.pdf.

Header

- ☐ Name, phone, school email, city, and LinkedIn URL. Nothing else.
- ☐ LinkedIn URL is customized (no random numbers) and the profile matches the resume.

Education

- ☐ School, degree, major, expected graduation month and year.
- ☐ GPA listed if it's 3.5 or higher; otherwise leave it off and be ready to answer if asked.
- ☐ Relevant coursework only if it's specific to the field (no "Intro to College Writing").
- ☐ High school listed in freshman year, with real achievements; drop it by junior year.

Experience bullets

- ☐ Every bullet starts with a strong past-tense verb (present tense only for current roles).
- ☐ Every bullet shows an outcome, not a duty: what changed because you were there.
- ☐ At least half the bullets have a number: people, dollars, hours, percent, count.
- ☐ Each bullet fits on one or two lines. No bullet you couldn't explain for two minutes.
- ☐ No filler phrases: "responsible for," "helped with," "various," "assisted in."

Leadership & activities

- ☐ Real roles with real bullets, not a list of club names.
- ☐ Jobs count: retail, food service, tutoring, family business. They show reliability.
- ☐ Projects count when they have a result (a model built, a site launched, an event run).

Skills & interests

- ☐ Only skills you can use in an interview tomorrow (Excel, SQL, Python, Figma, languages with level).
- ☐ Two or three specific interests that start conversations ("long-distance running," not "sports").

The 6-second test

- ☐ A stranger can tell what you're interested in within six seconds.
- ☐ The strongest item is in the top third of the page.
- ☐ Zero typos. Read it backwards, then have someone else read it.